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ISCEST NEWS

Issue 2

June 2024

ISCEST Proudly Represented at the NSBMB 2024 Conference!

The Nigerian Society of Biochemistry and Molecular Biology (NSBMB) held its 40th Scientific Conference from 23rd to 28th June 2024. The theme of the conference is *Global Health and Green Economy: Role of Biochemistry and Molecular Biology*. NSBMB was established in 1971. It empowers and strengthens scientists in the field of natural chemistry and atomic science to take part in broad research that prompts sustaining and satisfying outcomes.

Professor Matthew Wegwu, the current Vice President of ISCEST, is also the current President of NSBMB. This is one of those rare occasions when the highest-ranking

ISCEST members officiated at the same scholarly event. The ISCEST Family values and appreciates the invaluable service that its Vice President renders to NSBMB. ISCEST is also very proud of its leaders' representation at the event. See pp. 4 & 5 for Professor Azaiki and Professor Wegwu's addresses.



L-R: Prof. Nedie Akani, President ISCEST; Prof. Matthew Wegwu, Vice President, ISCEST; Prof. Steve Azaiki, Founding President, ISCEST

Publish Your Research Paper in CSCEST!



Current Studies in Comparative Education, Science and Technology (CSCEST) is ISCEST's Official Journal. The journal promotes interdisciplinary studies in education, science and technology. It publishes original research and papers that discuss, analyse or evaluate policies, or those that disclose relevant gaps in existing research. For more information on paper submission please visit <http://www.journal.iscest.org/>.

Heartfelt Congratulations to Professor Nedie Akani!!



ADUVIE
INTERNATIONAL SCHOOL

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No. 1 Aduvie Close, off Aduvie Way, near ABC Cargo Office, Jahi District, Abuja. Tel: +234 (0) 8089394474

E-mail: info@aduvieinternationalschool.org, aduvieinternationalschool@gmail.com

Website: www.aduvieinternationalschool.org

June 1, 2024

Prof. Nedie Patience Akani,
President,
International Society of Comparative Education, Science & Technology,
Yenegoa,
Bayelsa State.

Dear Prof. Akani,

APPOINTMENT INTO THE GOVERNING BOARD OF ADUVIE INTERNATIONAL SCHOOL

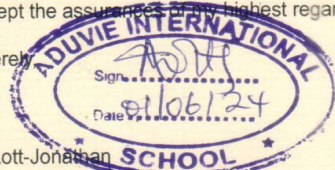
I write to intimate you of your well-deserved appointment into the Governing Board of Aduvie International School, as ratified by the Governing Board of Aduvie International School on the 4th of January, 2024. This appointment takes effect from June 2024

Aduvie International School is one of Nigeria's foremost schools, providing educational services in Creche, Nursery Primary, Secondary, as well as Pre-University Levels. The school is located at No. 1, Aduvie Close, Off Aduvie Way, Jahi, Abuja, Federal Capital Territory, Nigeria. Aduvie proudly has a 100% pass rate in WAEC, NECO, and IGCSE examinations. Our students have excelled in national competitions, winning the Microsoft National Championship five times and the Adobe National Championship twice. Additionally, we have achieved perfect scores in Checkpoint exams. This year, several of our students achieved scores exceeding 280 in JAMB.

You were nominated by Prof. Steve Azaiki, OON, who believes strongly that you would bring your wealth of experience in the academics, private sector and human capacity building, to bear on our institutions' development and progress. Please write formally to accept/reject this appointment by sending an email to headofschool@aduvieinternationalschool.org.

Please accept the assurance of our highest regards for your person and office.

Yours sincerely,



Dr. Ayima Lott-Jonathan
Chief Executive Officer/Proprietress

*Madame President, Congratulations on your appointment into the
Governing Board of Aduvie International School!!*

From the ISCEST Family

Professor Chiemela Enyinnaya Chinma Receives Award From Futminna

Professor Chiemela Enyinnaya Chinma of Food Science and Technology Department, Federal University of Technology Minna, Nigeria was among the recipients of awards of excellence presented by the Vice-Chancellor, Professor Faruk Adamu Kuta during the 3rd Researchers and Inventors Award ceremony held on 3rd June 2024 at the Federal University of Technology Minna, Nigeria. This is in recognition of his efforts in winning the National Research Fund (NRF) grant of the Tertiary Education Trust Fund (TETFund) and publishing in high impact factor (Q1) academic journals.



My biggest achievement more than any award is contributing in a winning cause for my team – Ravindra Jadeja.

Massive Congratulations to Professor C E Chinma et al from the ISCEST Family!!



Professor Azaiki's Address (From p.1)

Let me thank the President, members of the Executive and the Local organizing committee for inviting me to chair the Opening ceremony of the 40th Edition of the Annual scientific conference of the Nigerian Society of Biochemistry and Molecular Biology.



Prof. Steve Azaiki

The theme of this year's conference _ "Global health and Green Economy: The role of Biochemistry and Molecular Biology " is very apt. There is interconnection between good health and a functional economy. Biochemistry and Molecular Biology tools are needed to harness and marry the two.

The concept of Global health envisages security, health equity and global health governance. Effective Global health will among other things guarantee improved health outcomes and reduce mortality. Through a well thought out Global health programme will make for collaboration and knowledge sharing. These are indices for progress.

Not too long ago the world was faced with a pandemic covid-19. Scientific knowledge was shared. Biochemistry and Molecular Biology tools were handy to bring succour.

Green economy will reduce environmental risks and ecological scarcities, promote sustainable development and human wellbeing. The beauty of Green economy include :

1. Reliance on sustainable water management and conservation
2. Protection and restoration of natural habitat and ecosystems
3. Renewable energy sources
4. Inclusive and equitable agriculture and forestry practices among others.

These are issues very dear to people of the Niger Delta in particular and the world at large.

Rivers State is one of the States in Nigeria that has suffered environmental degradation due to fossil fuel exploration. Mr President, in your inaugural lecture some years back you described the experience of the Choba Community in Environmental disorientation as a consequence of pollution. Green economy is sure to mitigate the situation. Therefore the choice of university of Port Harcourt by the Nigeria society of Biochemistry and Molecular Biology to discuss this topic is commendable.

Uniport is a citadel of learning which cherishes Enlightenment and self-reliance. Research outputs of its Faculty had impacted global health and Green economy. It is thus well suited for experts in the field of Biochemistry and Molecular Biology to gather to rob minds, harness ideas and proffer solutions to this trending topic.

I am optimistic that this meeting will be exciting and rewarding. Welcome.

Professor Matthew Wegwu's Address (From p.1)

AN ADDRESS PRESENTED BY THE NATIONAL PRESIDENT, PROFESSOR MATTHEW OWHONDA WEGWU, AT THE OPENING CEREMONY OF THE 40TH SCIENTIFIC CONFERENCE AND ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING OF THE NIGERIAN SOCIETY OF BIOCHEMISTRY AND MOLECULAR BIOLOGY (NSBMB) WHICH HELD AT THE CENTRAL BANK CENTRE OF EXCELLENCE COMPLEX, UNIVERSITY PARK, UNIVERSITY OF PORT HARCOURT, CHOBA, ON TUESDAY, 25TH JUNE, 2024.



Prof. Matthew Wegwu

Order of Protocol

Very Distinguished Ladies and Gentlemen,

The National Executive Council, the Board of Trustees, Advisory Board and the entire members of Nigerian Society of Biochemistry and Molecular Biology are greatly humbled by your presence and feel deeply honoured to have you join us on this remarkable occasion of our 40th Scientific Conference and Annual General Meeting, which is a periodic reaffirmation of faith in our capacity to use the outcome of our scientific research and brainstorming session to better the human condition from our little corners of the planet.

It is, therefore, with a high sense of pride and gratitude that I warmly welcome all the eminent Biochemists and Molecular Biologists present in our midst today, including very distinguished guests who found time to grace this landmark gathering of the *crème de la crème* of Nigerian scientists. Our coming together today should not be viewed as one of those routine events or a chance encounter, but a well-articulated process that is dedicated to the pursuit of a greater purpose: finding credible solutions to some of the country's intractable health and economic problems. We are also gathered in this place to interact with one another and to celebrate pivotal research breakthroughs that have resulted in the emergence of new research fields, fantastic leaps in scientific understanding and novel biochemical and biological techniques that could be harnessed for wide-ranging applications.

Mr. Chairman, Sir, permit me to reiterate the critical role of NSBMB as a body of Biochemists and Molecular Biologists in Nigeria, specialized in exploring life processes. It is of utmost importance to emphasize that the disciplines of Biochemistry and Molecular Biology have applications in medicine, food technology, nutrition, toxicology, plant therapeutics, pharmaceuticals, drug development and pharmacology, applied biology and biotechnology, agriculture, oil and gas, environmental degradation, environmental pollution and health, Sports Science, forensic science, product standardization, brewery industry, cosmetics, textile and other allied industries.

The diverse nature of Biochemistry and Molecular Biology in other advanced climes has enabled healthy collaborations and multi-disciplinary result-oriented research products that have contributed to the sustenance of their economy, even in the face of the current global economic meltdown and disruption of supply chains around the world. It is beyond debate to note that research collaborations create an enabling environment for researchers to leverage on each other's experience, expertise, recourses and connections in the quest for finding creative scientific solutions to seemingly impossible local and global problems.

(Cont'd on page 8)

Part of an Interesting Report about NASENI

Like China & Japan: National Agency for Science and Engineering Infrastructure (NASENI), Path To Nigeria's Industrial Economy

By Olusegun Ayeoyenikan - June 19, 2024

Nigeria cannot achieve real development without sustainable industrial growth and manufacturing capacity, essential to addressing poverty, unemployment, and insecurity. Establishing a robust industrial goods production base and a competitive industrial economy is crucial to reducing Nigeria's dependence on imported goods, technologies, and services.

An industrial economy is characterised by the prevalent use of machines, equipment, or technologies in industry and business. This involves combining various factors such as innovation, production, facilities, supplies, work, and knowledge to produce material goods or services for the market. The presence of sophisticated infrastructure and investments in science, technology, and innovation systems drives a nation's industrial production and manufacturing capabilities. This determines the nation's competitiveness in producing processed and manufactured goods, linking industrial activities with the primary sector, local or international trade, and services.

When a nation lacks these factors, it faces industrial underdevelopment, leading to poor social and economic conditions. Countries like Japan and China, which were initially not part of the European nations that experienced the first and second industrial revolutions, have rapidly advanced to join the League of industrialised countries by investing in research and development (R&D), innovation, science, and technology. The Asian Tigers—Malaysia, Singapore, Thailand, and others—discovered the importance of substantial investments in science and innovation much earlier than many African nations, including Nigeria.

The Importance of Science and Technology

Science, technology, engineering research, and innovation are essential for meaningful industrialisation. For Nigeria, prioritizing these areas in economic recovery and growth plans is crucial. Without this focus, any achieved success will be short-lived or unsustainable. Countries like Japan, the USA, China, Germany, and Indonesia have gained their reputation as economic giants due to their leaders' previous commitments to R&D investments, earmarking 5-6 per cent of their gross domestic products (GDP) for developing science, technology, and innovation (STI). Investment in STI is a core development factor and the secret behind advanced nations' leadership and commitment.

Source: <https://sciencenigeria.com/>

Students Set to Improve Their Skills!

600 Postgraduate Students Compete for PTDF Scholarship in Rivers State, Nigeria

By Obinna Nwaoku, Port Harcourt

About 600 shortlisted Masters and Doctorate candidates were recently interviewed for the 2024/2025 overseas scholarship scheme by the Petroleum Technology Development Fund (PTDF) in Port Harcourt, the Rivers State capital.

Addressing journalists on the scheme, General Manager, PTDF, Mrs Ifeoma Nwokike, said the initiative was aimed at providing Nigerian students with the intellectual foundation and skills set needed to participate actively in the country's oil and gas industry.

She said candidates who scaled through the rigorous selection process would be sent to elite tertiary institutions abroad, especially the United Kingdom

Nwokike said the students are expected to return to the country after they train to bridge identified gaps in the oil and gas industry with their expertise.

She said, "Our mandate is to build capacity in the oil and gas industry, and we have been mandated to train Nigerians in different skills to fill some of the identified gaps."

Nwokike disclosed that the selection interview would hold simultaneously across the six geopolitical zones.

The team lead for the overseas scholarship interview, Port Harcourt Centre, Mr Ere Iyalla, said the 600 students for the zone were shortlisted based on their results at the ordinary and undergraduate levels, as well as research proposal and statement of purpose that fit into the needs of the oil and gas industry.

Source: <https://guardian.ng/600-postgraduate-students-compete-for-ptdf-scholarship-in-rivers/>

A BIG WIN for Nigeria!

Nigerian Students Win Big at ICT Competition in China

By Bridget Chiedu Onochie, Abuja



Four teams from Nigeria have secured two grand prizes and two first prizes at the Huawei ICT Competition 2023-2024 Global Final held in Shenzhen, China, on May 26.

At the competition designed to help students enhance their ICT knowledge and practical skills, the Nigerian teams emerged as part of 19 teams from nine countries that won the Grand Prizes of the Practice and Innovation Competitions.

This 8th edition of the Huawei ICT Competition, themed “Connection, Glory and Future,” attracted more than 170,000 students from over 2,000 universities and colleges across more than 80 countries and regions, making it the largest offline competition since its launch.

More than 160 teams, consisting of over 470 contestants from 49 different countries and regions, made it through national and regional competitions to reach this year’s global final. The Nigeria team, comprising four students from the University of Ibadan – Rufus Olusoji Adisa, Tolani Adekunle Adisa, Chibueze Emmanuel Ibekwe, and Lawrence Chukwuemeka, won the grand prize in the Computing Track category. In the Cloud Track category, another Nigeria team also from the University of Ibadan won the grand prize. The students include Lukman Oyeniyi Abdulyekeen, Sodiq Babawale, and Temiloluwa Oloye.

Two teams from the Federal University of Technology, Minna, also won first prizes in the Network Track category. Students in Team 1 include Knimi Bakna Musa, Kaosar Salaudeen Ahmad, Taiye Ayantola, and Oluwagbemiga Victor Ogundele, while Team 2 consists of Justus Ilegieuno, Yusuf Olanrewaju Toye, and Jamiu Damilare Dahunsi. The Nigerian students beat thousands of competitors at the national level competition, testing a range of practical and theoretical digital skills, and represented Nigeria at the regional level contest where they qualified for the finals in China. Speaking at the event, the President of Huawei’s ICT Strategy and Business Development Department, Ritchie Peng, described ICT as the cornerstone of the intelligent world. “ICT is the cornerstone of the intelligent world. Through the Huawei ICT Competition, we aim to provide students with a global platform to compete and exchange ideas.”

Also speaking, the President of Huawei’s Institute of Strategic Research, Zhou Hong, disclosed the company’s interest in providing opportunities for enjoying digitalisation.

“To make sure everyone can truly enjoy the benefits of digitalisation while such technologies are making radical progress, Huawei believes it is crucial to guarantee that digital technologies are accessible to all.”

(Cont’d on page 9)

A BIG WIN for Nigeria! (From p.8)

On the same day, Huawei also held the ICT Accelerating Education Transformation Summit. At the summit, Huawei awarded 24 instructors with the title “Huawei ICT Academy Global Most Valuable Instructor,” which was the first of its kind.

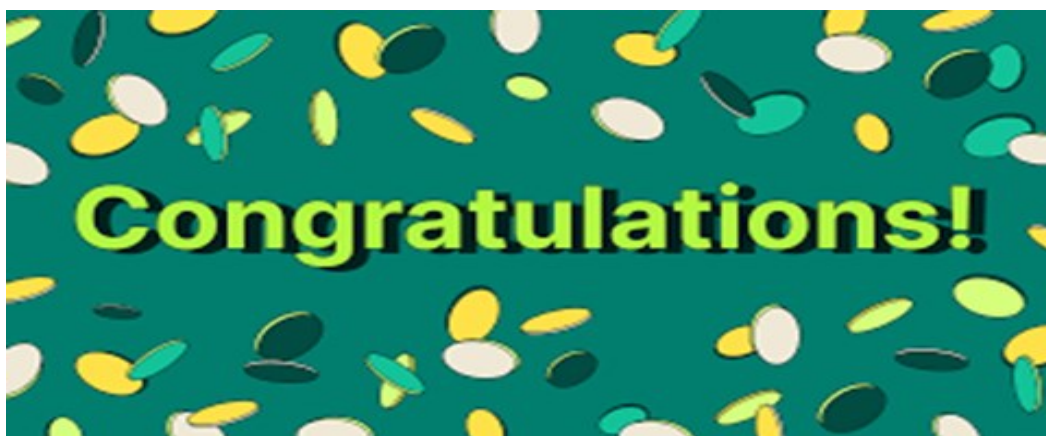
The award aimed to show gratitude for the important contributions these instructors have made to talent development, and mark them as role models that show how the brightest minds can develop even brighter minds. These role models will help drive the sustainable development of the ICT talent ecosystem.

The Huawei ICT Competition is an annual contest held by Huawei for global university and college students. Through the competition, Huawei aims to provide students with an international platform for healthy competition and the exchange of ideas.

Since its launch in 2015, the competition has helped students enhance their ICT knowledge and practical skills, while also increasing their ability to innovate by using new technologies and platforms. The goal is to advance technological development and facilitate digital inclusion around the world.

Congratulations!!!

The ISCEST Family extends heartfelt congratulations to the Nigeria team from the University of Ibadan – Rufus Olusoji Adisa, Tolani Adekunle Adisa, Chibueze Emmanuel Ibekwe, and Lawrence Chukwuemeka.



Professor Matthew Wegwu's Address (From p.5)

In Nigeria, however, such collaborations are yet to be encouraged by university administrators who in their innocence, are yet to appreciate the indispensability of our programmes in the sustainability of life sciences. The best illustration of the misconception of the nature of **Biochemistry and Molecular Biology** by some Nigerians in the academia is the story of a group of blind men who have never come across an elephant before and tried to learn and imagine what the big animal was like by feeling it. Interestingly, each blind man touched a different part of the elephant. They then described the animal based on their limited experience and their descriptions of the elephant differed from each other.

This misconception explains the reason we are located in different Faculties in different universities in the country: while at the University of Nigeria, Nsukka, the Department of Biochemistry is housed in the College of biological Sciences, it is located in the Faculty of Basic and applied Sciences at the University of Lagos. Even more bizarre is the fact that in some universities, the Department is split into two: Faculty of Science (or Natural Sciences) and Faculty of Basic Medical Sciences etc.

Distinguished Chairman, Sir, I am confident that this ugly development would best be resolved through the creation of Faculty of Biochemistry and Molecular Biology, with the following Departments:

Department of Medical Biochemistry

Department of Molecular Biology

Department of Nutritional and Toxicological Biochemistry

Department of Food and Agricultural Biochemistry

Department of Environmental and Industrial Biochemistry

Department of Enterprising Biochemistry(currently flourishing in Europe)

Department of Pharmaceutical, Drug Development and Forensic Biochemistry

Department of Trado-Medicinal Biochemistry

Department of Sports Biochemistry

Fellow Scholars, recent developments have facilitated the speedy arrival of **Biochemistry and Molecular Biology Programmes** in Nigeria to the dreaded boundary between its continuous existence and extinction. The insistence by the **Medical and Dental Council of Nigeria (MDCN)** that only medically qualified academics should head the Department of Medical Biochemistry and teach medical students; coupled with the utterly inexplicable exclusion of Biochemistry students from having their **Industrial Work Experience** in medical laboratories in the country by the **Medical Laboratory Science Council of Nigeria (MLCN)** , has raised serious doubts among parents and Biochemistry students on the relevance of Biochemists and Molecular Biologists in Nigeria.

(To be continued in the next issue of ISCEST News)

Attend International Education Conferences!



Envisioning Education in a Digital
Society CIES 2025
Annual Conference Chicago, IL
March 22-26, 2025

03 September 2024 - 05
September 2024

The University of Sussex
Falmer, Brighton , BN1 9RH



26th Annual Conference
20-23 August 2024
Navigating Internationalisation In
Challenging Times

2024 Conference on Global Learning

October 24-26, 2024

Westin Washington, DC Downtown



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A Reminder from the ISCEST President!

International Society of Comparative Educa- tion, Science and Technology (ISCEST) XI Annual International Conference 01 – 03 December 2024 Call For Papers



Professor Nedie Akani

December 2024 begins the period when the Interna-
tional Society of Comparative Education, Science and
Technology (ISCEST) celebrates its 10th Anniversary.

As part of the celebration, ISCEST is convening its first face-to-face Annual
International Conference since 2019. The theme for this celebratory confer-
ence is ***Nationalising International Comparative Education Spaces:
Propositions, Prospects and Praxes***. An invitation to participate is extend-
ed to academics, researchers, teachers, students, consultants, policy makers,
curriculum developers and other interested professionals.

Abstracts should be sent to: iscestnigeria@gmail.com

Deadline for submission of Abstracts: **30th October 2024**

Abstract acceptance notification: **15th November 2024**

Abstracts should be sent electronically to: Editors@iscest.org.

Thank You!

*“Thank You” are two little words
But they mean so very much
To show how grateful we are
That you have kept in touch*

Gertrude Shotte

